

Response System v0.1 (Design Brief)

Layers & Overrides

- Engine Defaults: built-in generic responses for all intents.
- Genre Pack Overrides: genre-specific tone and vocabulary.
- Game Pack Overrides: adventure-specific flavour and story context.
- Local Overrides: room/object/NPC-specific lines.
- Fallback chain: local → game → genre → engine.

Structure

- Each intent has variants: success, failure, blocked, missing_target.
- Templates support variables such as {target}, {npc}, {reason}.
- Random selection: lists of interchangeable lines for nuance/texture.
- Style flags: tone (neutral/dark/humorous), voice (narrator/diegetic), brevity.

Profanity Mode (Player Controlled)

- Modes: off | mild | strong | raw.
- Shapes narrator/NPC reactions to player insults.
- Example behaviour:
 - * off: polite rebuke.
 - * mild: softened warning.
 - * strong: masked profanity.
 - * raw: direct uncensored retort.
- NPC/persona caps can limit maximum profanity level.

Built-In Generic Responses

- Missing object/NPC: "You don't see that here."
- Invalid action: "You can't do that right now."
- Locked/blocked: "It won't budge."
- Failed condition: "Something's preventing that."
- Profanity handling per selected mode.

User-Created & Pack Responses

- Packs can override engine defaults by reusing the same keys.
- Missing keys fall back to higher layers in the response chain.
- Packs may supply lists of variant lines for natural variation.
- Optional conditional variants planned for future expansion.

Notes

- Keep engine defaults clean and universal.
- Genre and game packs define flavour.
- NPCs and objects override only what is relevant.